

Analyse Logs with Elasticsearch



We often need to search and analyse the logs of our Windows based computer or server to get an insight into the system or application. Such analysis gets easier if the logs are sent to Elasticsearch. This article is a step-by-step guide on how to integrate Winlogbeat and Sysmon with Elasticsearch.

Winlogbeat is a tool that runs as a service on a MS Windows based computer and is capable of sending Windows logs to Elasticsearch for analysis. It's an open source and free tool to keep a tab on what's happening in your Windows based system. It streams Windows event logs to Elasticsearch and Logstash.

Installation of Winlogbeat

For installing Winlogbeat on a Windows computer, follow the steps given below.

Step 1: Go to the download link and download the Winlogbeat zip file by selecting your system architecture. The link is <https://www.elastic.co/downloads/beats/winlogbeat/>.

Step 2: Once the download process is done, extract the contents in the zip file to *C:\Program Files*. Rename the folder as *Winlogbeat* for later use.

Step 3: Now open PowerShell as *Administrator* and navigate to the directory *C:\Program Files\winlogbeat*.

Step 4: Enter the following command in PowerShell:

```
.\install-service-winlogbeat.ps1
```

The output of the above command should look like what's shown in Figure 1.

If you get an error like 'Script execution is disabled', then run the following command:

```
PowerShell.exe -ExecutionPolicy UnRestricted -File .\install-service-winlogbeat.ps1
```

```
PS C:\Program Files\winlogbeat> powershell.exe -ExecutionPolicy UnRestricted -File .\install-service-winlogbeat.ps1

Security warning
Run only scripts that you trust. While scripts from the internet can be useful, this script can potentially harm your
computer. If you trust this script, use the Unblock-File cmdlet to allow the script to run without this warning
message. Do you want to run C:\Program Files\winlogbeat\install-service-winlogbeat.ps1?
[D] Do not run [R] Run once [S] Suspend [?] Help (default is "D"): R

Status  Name          DisplayName
-----
Stopped winlogbeat    winlogbeat
```

Figure 1: Service installation in PowerShell